

School Health



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Outlines



- ✓ Introduction
- ✓ Definition of school nursing , school health programs, school health team & school health services
- ✓ Needs of school age group
- ✓ Common health problems of school age (young age 6-12 years, adolescent age 13-19 years of age)
- ✓ Main cause of morbidity & mortality among school children



Outlines

- Components of school health programs
 - Health services.
 - Health education.
 - Healthy environment
- Characteristics & importance of healthy school environment
- Classification of Physical school environment:
 - Classified into 2 aspects:-
 - External school environment
 - internal school environment
- The role of the school nurse



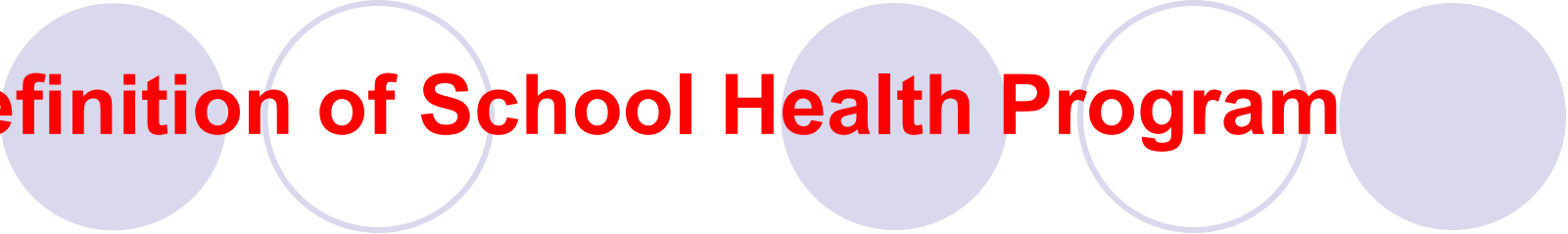
Introduction

Most children are spending more time in school than in any other activity. This makes the school nurse a primary resource in recognizing and managing children's health problems. School health is concerned with health of school children who form a vulnerable of the population who need special school health program because they are constantly growing and developing.



Definition of School Nursing

School nursing is specialized practices of professional nursing that maintain the well being, academic success and life-long achievement of students. School nurses facilitate positive student responses to normal development; promote health, safety & intervention with actual and potential health problems.



Definition of School Health Program

School health program is an important component of community health through the primary responsibility for the health school aged children lives with their parents, their families and eventually the health of the community.

❖ **School health team** should include representation from administrator, food service workers, maintenance workers, social workers , teachers and medical personnel especially a school nurse and school physician

❖ **School health services** are health services provided by physician, nurses, dentists, health educators, social workers and teachers to protect and promote health of students and school personnel.

Needs of school age group

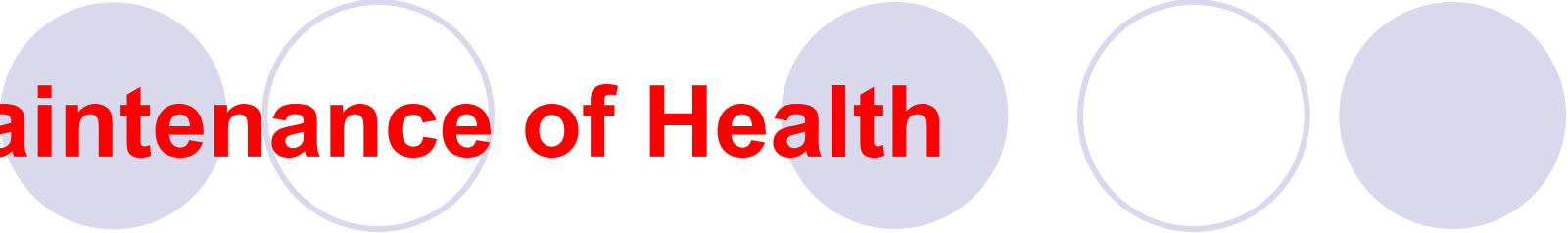
❖ **Nutritional needs:**

- ✓ They need 2000 calories/ day. 30% protein, 20% fat. 50% CHO, vitamins, minerals and water.
- ✓ School age children can eat the general family diet with exception of tea and coffee.
- ✓ Snacks are most likely to be the primary source of nutrients for the school age children.

Five circles are arranged horizontally at the top of the slide. From left to right: a solid light purple circle, an empty circle with a light purple outline, a solid light purple circle, an empty circle with a light purple outline, and a solid light purple circle.

❖ Protection from infection

- ✓ Booster immunization.
- ✓ Healthful school environment.
- ✓ Daily observation of all students for early detection of any disease or problem.
- ✓ Screening for infectious diseases as skin disease & scabies.
- ✓ Prevention of communicable diseases



Maintenance of Health

- ✓ Prevention of accidents.
- ✓ A void noise and noisy places around school
- ✓ Adequate recreational facilities
- ✓ Good ventilation in classrooms.
- ✓ Adequate natural and artificial lighting.
- ✓ Safe water supply
- ✓ Clean toilets and insect control.

Exercises

- School must contain a wide play area
- School must have school program should include physical training to improve the circulation of blood and help in muscle flexibility.
- Teach children the ideal body mechanism e.g. proper positioning while sitting, reading & writing .

Rest and sleep:

- The school student needs adequate periods of rest and sleep

Curative services

- Treatment of any minor disease
- Referral through health care system.
- Emergency care and first aid.



Psycho-social needs

School age student needs security, safety, and peer group interaction. They need organized games for team play

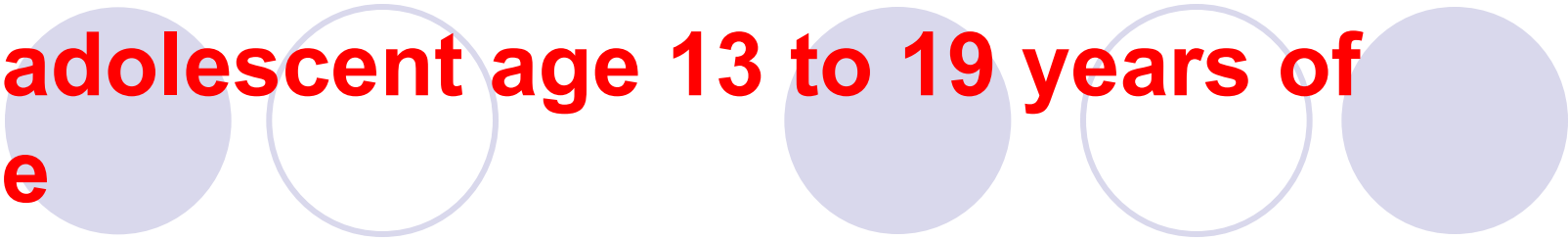
Health education

Good educational program for prevention of spread of disease. The student must understand the meaning of health and create health.

The common health problems of young school age (6-12) years are:

- ❖ Accidents
- ❖ Respiratory diseases
- ❖ Dental diseases
- ❖ Nutritional problems
- ❖ School phobia
- ❖ Infections

In adolescent age 13 to 19 years of age

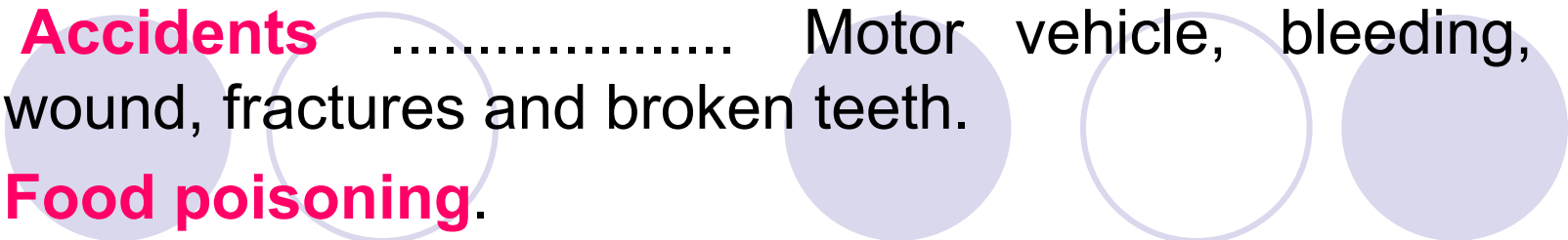


- ❖ Mental and emotional problems
- ❖ Menstrual disabilities
- ❖ Sexually transmitted diseases
- ❖ Other health problems: as sports injuries, dental decay and accidents

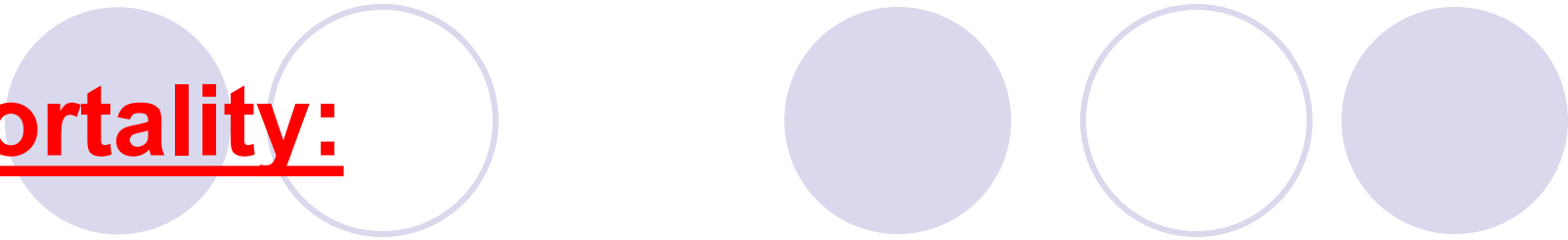
Main causes of morbidity and mortality among school children.

- **Morbidity:**

- ✓ **Parasitic diseases**..... Ascaris.
- ✓ **Respiratory diseases**..... Influenza
tonsillitis, laryngitis, bronchi- pneumonia.
- ✓ **Skin diseases**..... Scabies
- ✓ **Rheumatic fever.**
- ✓ **Infectious diseases** Mumps,
typhoid and paratyphoid, whooping cough.
- ✓ **Dental problems** dental caries
- ✓ **Eye diseases**..... Defective vision and
conjunctivitis

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- ✓ **Accidents** Motor vehicle, bleeding, wound, fractures and broken teeth.
 - ✓ **Food poisoning.**
 - ✓ **Handicaps** visual and mental retardation.
 - ✓ **Emotional problems** Fear, worries, frustration, insecurity and conflict.
 - ✓ **Deficiency disease** Protein deficiency leading to impaired growth, iron deficiency leading to anemia.
 - ✓ **Blood Disorders** Leukemia, anemia and Thalassemia.

Mortality:



- **Accidents:** falls, head injury, RTA (Road traffic-accidents), home accidents... etc.
- **Infections diseases:** Progressive stages.
- **Rheumatic fever:** Complications

School health program

Objectives:

- To change beliefs and practices of school children by providing them with adequate knowledge of good healthy habit.
- To provide a comprehensive school health program that deals with the physical, mental, and social health needs and problems of this population.
- To reduce morbidity and mortality of school age population to improve their quality of life.

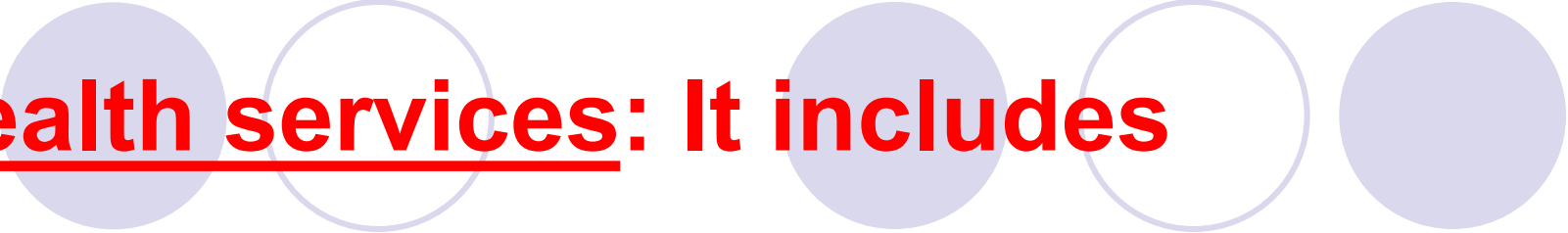
Components of school health program:

- Health services.
- Health education.
- Healthy environment



Components of the school health program





Health services: It includes

- ✓ Screening.
- ✓ Case finding.
- ✓ Surveillance of immunization status.
- ✓ Managing minor complaints.
- ✓ Administration of medication.
- ✓ Counseling.
- ✓ Case management.
- ✓ Health services for students with special needs.

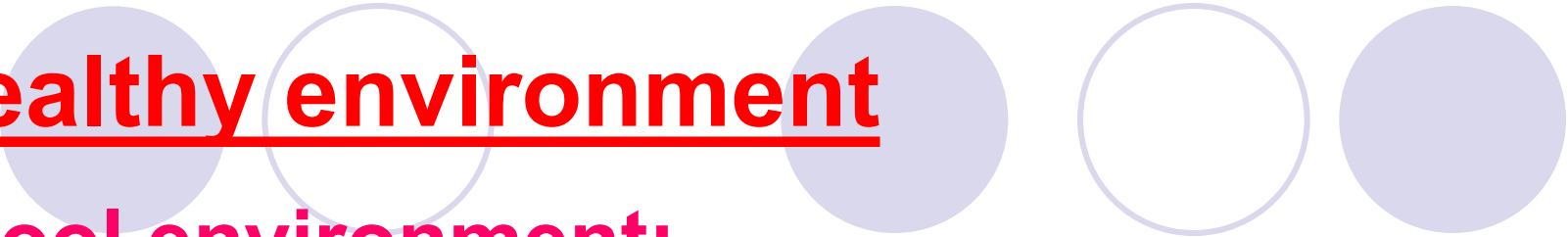
School Health Education

Objectives:

- To assess and identify the health problems and needs among children requiring health education.
- To educate the students to form a healthy behavior.
- To educate the students about prevention of diseases.
- To educate the student about their well-being.
- To use the student as messengers to convey health back home to their families.

Topics of Health Education

- ✓ Personal cleanliness as oral health, care of eye, ear, nose, skin, hair and feet.
- ✓ Food and nutrition.
- ✓ Bad Life- style as smoking, alcohol and drugs.
- ✓ Common health problems among children.
- ✓ First Aid.
- ✓ Infectious disease.



C. Healthy environment

School environment:

Is the surrounding area of the student at the school and around the school.

Importance of healthy school environment:

- Promotes optimum psychological & physical growth and developmental among school age students
- Essential to students & staff achievement and develop attitudes & behavior that value healthy life style.

Characteristics of healthy school environment:



- ✓ Should be safe from physical, chemical, psychological environmental hazards.
- ✓ Comfortable environment has adequate seating, lighting, ventilation, heating, toileting facilities and drinking fountains.
- ✓ Provision of emergency care & adequate transportation
- ✓ Safe and sanitary condition of the school.
- ✓ School design put into consideration the needs of disabled students & staff.

Classification of healthy school environment:

Classified into 2 aspects:-

- **Physical environment** (Sanitation, lighting and safety issue)
- **Psychological environment** (includes relations between humans inside the school)

Classification of Physical school environment

Classified into 2 aspects:-

- ✓ External school environment
- ✓ Internal school environment

External school environment

Site or school location should be:-

- ✓ Should be central to district.
- ✓ Easily accessible to the ordinary means of transport.
- ✓ Away from noise.
- ✓ Street leading to school must be wide enough.
- ✓ School should be far from the sources of pollution and should be in good ventilated area.
- ✓ School should have more than one enters for the students

Role of the school nurse in school health program:-

A) Healthful school environment

1-Physical environment :-

- * The nurse must link with the staff in ensuring that there is a high standard of environmental hygiene (water, sanitation , latrines)
- * Daily rounds in the classes to be sure that there is good ventilation & good lighting.
- * Daily round in the bathrooms to ensure adequate water supply and proper sewage disposal.



*Write a report on the building in a special book and present it to administrator and the physician .

2- Non-physical environment :-

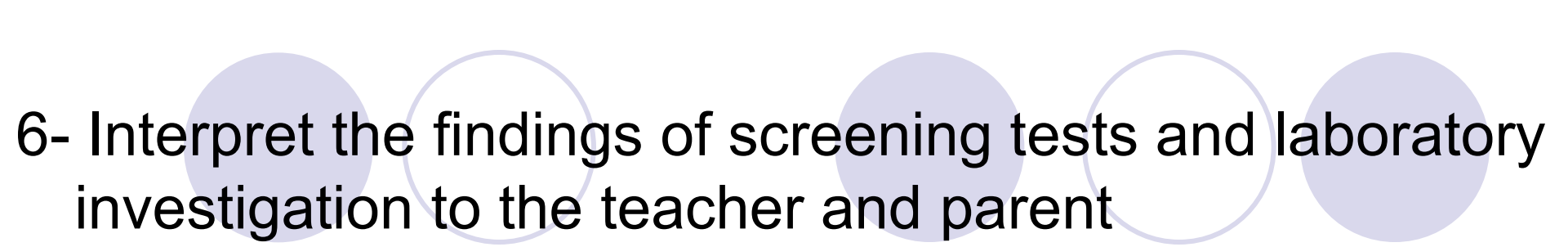
- *The nurse must involve teachers and parents in children's problems
- *Promote good teacher student relationship .

B) School health services:-

1-Preventive activities:-

a)-Health appraisal :-

- 1- Taking history (personal, family ,medical history)
- 2- Health observation signs of sickness and deviation from normal
- 3- Prepare students to screening tests and laboratory investigations
- 4-Screen vision, hearing and measure weight and height
- 5- Help in laboratory investigations

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- 6- Interpret the findings of screening tests and laboratory investigation to the teacher and parent
 - 7-Conduct special surveys to detect any health problem

b) Follow up and counseling for the children deviated from normal.

c) Prevention and control of communicable disease:-

- 1- Provide immunization
- 2- Daily observation of students for early case findings , referral and isolation .
- 3- Prevention and control of outbreaks of infections.

4- provide health teaching about period of isolation.

5- Care of contacts.

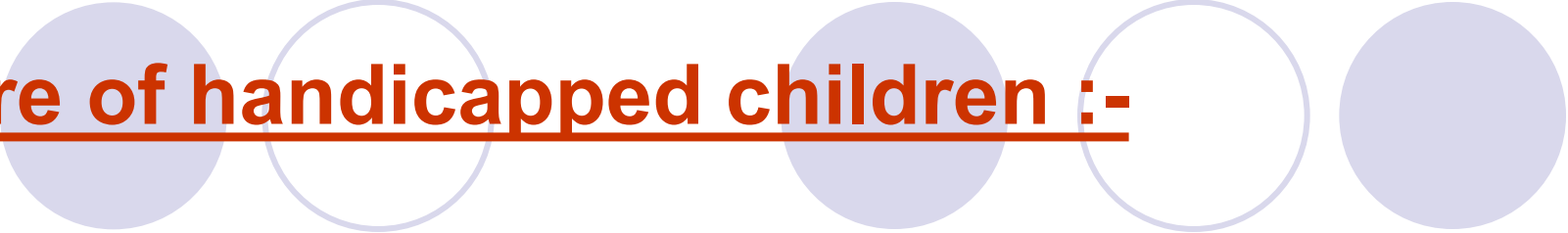
6- care of absence .

7- be sure that food handlers in the school pass through physical examination and have health certificate .

d) Early case finding and referral of non – communicable diseases and parasitic disease .

e) Emergency care and first aid :-

- * The nurse is responsible to carry out first aid treatment for the injured due to accident and if necessary transfer them to hospital or clinics.
- Be sure that there is enough first aid equipment and supplies in the school to carry out first aid .



f- Care of handicapped children :-

- * Identify student with handicapped problem (e.g., hearing problem or vision ,epilepsy , mobility difficulties) and arrange referral,treatment and support .
- *Help handicapped students to accommodate with their defects .

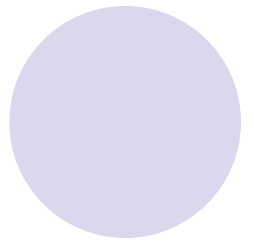
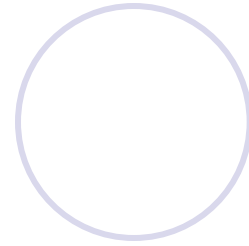
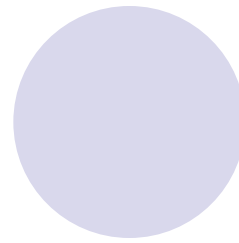
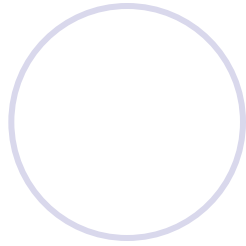
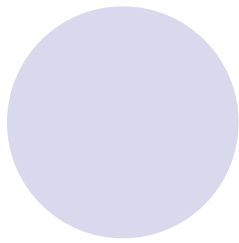
2- Curative activities:-

- 1- Referral for treatment of any discovered diseases.
- 2-Children is need of medical treatment or special care should be identified (as child with learning problems)
- 3- Provide medication for children with chronic diseases .
- 4-Filling health records and keeping it .
- 5-Interpret the finding and recording the progress in special record .
- 6-Keep the health records available to teachers and physicians.

The role of the school nurse

- The school nurse implements programs and services designed to provide for the early detection and follow-up of health problems, and referral,
- The school nurse uses the nursing process to assess, plan, implement, and evaluate care for students with chronic health conditions.
- The school nurse provides leadership for the provision of health services.

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- **The school nurse as a case manager,** the nurse communicates with the family through telephone calls, Assures them with written communication and home visits as needed.



Thank You

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